

Flash Fill, Text to Columns, Basic Functions.

1. ~~How do you calculate loan payments using the PMT function?~~ What is flash fill?

→ Flash fill is a feature in excel that automatically recognizes patterns in data and fills the remaining cells accordingly. It works by analyzing the examples entered by the user and applying the same pattern to adjacent cells. Flash fill is especially useful for extracting, combining, or reformatting text without using formulas. It can be activated automatically or manually using $Ctrl + E$ from the data tab.

2. How would you use flash fill to reformat data in columns?

→ To reformat data using Flash fill, enter the desired format manually in the first cell next to the original data. Once excel detects the pattern, it shows a preview of the filled values. Press enter or $Ctrl + E$ to apply the format to the entire column. For example, converting "Omkar R" to "R", "Omkar" can be done by typing the first result and using flash fill.

3. Can you explain the process of splitting data into columns using text to columns?

→ Text to columns is used to split text from one column into multiple columns. First, select the column containing the data. Then go to the data tab → Text to columns. Choose either Delimited (if data is separated by characters like commas) or fixed width (if data is aligned in fixed positions).

④ what are some common delimiters used in the Text Columns feature?

→ common delimiters used in Text to columns include comma (,), space, tab, semicolon (;), and pipe (|). These delimiters help ~~excel~~ excel identify where the data should be split. users can also specify a custom delimiter if the required separator is not listed.

⑤ How do you use the len functions to count the number of characters in a cell?

→ The LEN function is used to count the total number of characters in a text string, including spaces. The syntax is =LEN(text).

For example, $=LEN("Excel functions")$

returns 15. This function is commonly used in data validation, text analysis, and cleaning data.

⑥ What is the purpose of the SUBSTITUTE function and how is it used?

→ The SUBSTITUTE function replaces specific text in a string with new text. Its syntax is $=SUBSTITUTE(text, old-text, new-text, [instance-number])$.

For example.

$=SUBSTITUTE("2026/01/22", "/", "-")$

Converts the data format by replacing slashes with hyphens. It is useful for ~~data~~ cleaning and standardizing data.

⑦ How would you combine the CONCATENATE function with Flash Fill?

→ First, use the CONCATENATE function to combine data from different columns into one cell. Then, Flash Fill can be used to apply similar combinations across other rows without formulas. For example, after combining first and last names once,

Flash Fill can automatically repeat the pattern for the remaining data, making the process faster and easier.

8) Explain the difference between the REPT function and the SUBSTITUTE function.

→ The REPT function repeats a text string a specified number of times, whereas the SUBSTITUTE function replaces existing text with new text. REPT is used for formatting or visual effects (like repeating symbols). While SUBSTITUTE is used for modifying or cleaning text data. Both functions serve different purposes in text manipulation!

9) How can you use Text to Columns to convert text to dates?

→ Text to Columns can convert text formatted dates into proper excel date values. Select the column, go to data → Text to Columns, choose delimited or fixed width, and proceed to the final step. In the column data format select date and choose the correct

format (DMY, MDY, etc.) click finish to convert the text into dates.

(10) What is the significance of the flash fill preview in excel.?

→ The flash fill preview shows how excel intends to fill the data based on the detected pattern.

- It allows users to verify accuracy before applying changes. If the preview is correct the user can accept it; if not they can modify the example. This feature helps prevent error and ensures correct data formatting.